Building Your Alumni List with Claude Cowork

Three steps to a working outreach tracker

The Three Steps

Step 1 Connect. Google Drive into Cowork, one folder, one tracker. Ten minutes, once.

Step 2 Source. Pull names from the channels built for alumni outreach. Cowork files them as you go.

Step 3 Run. Cowork drafts the outreach, logs the calls, and holds you to the follow-up.

Step 1 — Connect Cowork to Your Drive

Open Claude Cowork on desktop. Go to Settings, then Connectors, and add Google Drive. Grant access to a single recruiting folder rather than your entire Drive.

Make one folder and keep everything in it — the tracker, your resume, your call notes. Then tell Cowork what to build:

> *"Create a Google Sheet in my Recruiting folder called Alumni Tracker. Columns: Name, Grad Year, Firm, Group, City, How I Found Them, Status, First Contact, Call Date, Follow-Up Due, Referred By, Notes."*

Cowork creates the sheet, holds the link, and writes to it for the rest of the cycle. You should never format a column by hand.

Step 2 — Source the Names

Do not scrape LinkedIn. Automated scraping violates LinkedIn's User Agreement and gets accounts restricted — including the account a banker checks before your call. Scraped lists also produce blast emails, which is the fastest way to get ignored. Use the channels built for this:

- **Your school's alumni database.** Career services has one, it is searchable by employer, the contacts opted in, and almost nobody in your class is using it.
- **The LinkedIn Alumni tool.** Your school's page, then Alumni, then filter by where they work and what they do. Browse it yourself and connect one at a time.
- **Club, team, and house rosters.** Your investment club, fraternity, and sports team keep alumni lists. These convert highest — shared affiliation is the strongest possible open.
- **Firm websites.** Analyst and associate bios list schools. Public, current, and free.
- **Professors and Handshake.** Finance faculty place students every year and will make introductions if you ask directly.

File each name the moment you find it:

> *"Add to Alumni Tracker: Sarah Kim, '19, Evercore, M&A, New York, found through the investment club alumni list, status Not Contacted."*

On email addresses. Ask for the introduction instead of guessing the address. A warm intro, a LinkedIn message, or a hand-off from career services gets a reply. A guessed address lands in a spam filter, and when it doesn't, it announces that you guessed.

Step 3 — Run the Cadence

Work the list through Cowork rather than through the sheet:

> *"Show me everyone in the tracker with a follow-up due this week."*
>
> *"Draft a LinkedIn message to Sarah Kim. Reference the investment club, ask for twenty minutes, under ninety words."*
>
> *"Just got off with Sarah. Log the call, set the thank-you for tonight and the check-in for eight weeks out."*

Three rules for anything Cowork drafts: read it before it goes, rewrite at least one line so it sounds like you, and never send the same message twice.

The tracker exists to enforce the follow-up. Most students make one round of contact and stop. The check-in six to eight weeks later, carrying a real update, is what turns a call into a referral.

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